

GAUNTLET v0.6

INTELLIGENCE FACTION GUIDE

DEFINITIVE FACTION INSERT

This guide contains the complete player-facing Intelligence rules, Ranger and Spymaster, supplemental references, resource tracking, and canonical twelve-card pool. Use it with the Gauntlet v0.6 core rules.

1. Intelligence overview

The Intelligence faction turns incomplete information into deliberate action. Its cards reveal commitments, protect or revise hidden objectives, disrupt opposing plans, and prepare operations that mature over several turns. Intelligence may still win by running the Gauntlet, but it can also coordinate a decisive Special Operation after completing enough normal Missions.

FACTION IDENTITY

Learn enough to act with confidence, but never so much that gathering information replaces acting on the board.

VICTORY	Run the Gauntlet or complete a Special Operation.
RESOURCES	Intel and Operation Progress. Both begin at 0.
CORE SYSTEM	Start one face-down Mission; satisfy its printed requirement; complete it later for Intel and Operation Progress.
BATTLE TOOLS	Spend Intel on Surveillance and Interference.
LEADERS	Ranger — terrain and hostile-ground operations. Spymaster — Mission tempo and network coordination.
FACTION POOL	12 unique cards; curve 1 / 3 / 4 / 3 / 1 at costs 1–5.
STATEMENT CARD	Sleeper Network, cost 5 and Unique.

Components and setup

- Choose the Ranger or Spymaster Leader Card.
- Keep the Mission Reference and Operations Reference available.
- Set Intel and Operation Progress to 0 on the Intelligence Resource Tracker.
- Use the normal deck-construction rules for all playable Intelligence cards.
- Only a card with a printed Mission requirement may become a Mission or Special Operation.

2. Intel, Missions, and Operation Progress

INTEL	OPERATION PROGRESS
• Begins at 0 and has no maximum. • Spent on Surveillance, Interference, Fieldcraft, Mission abortion, the final Special Operation cost, and card effects. • Normal Missions are the primary source.	• Begins at 0 and is not normally spent. • Each completed normal Mission adds exactly 1. • Readiness for Special Operation requires Progress greater than opposing controlled Territories.

Starting a Mission

During the Action phase after movement, instead of playing an Action card, place one Intelligence card from your hand with a printed Mission requirement face down near your Leader Card as your Active Mission.

- You may look at it at any time.
- You may have only one Active Mission.
- You cannot have an Active Mission and a Special Operation simultaneously.
- It cannot complete on the turn it begins.
- Its requirement counts only while it is the Active Mission.

Completing a Mission

COMPLETION SEQUENCE

During the Action phase after movement, reveal a satisfied Active Mission instead of playing an Action card. Increase Operation Progress by 1, gain Intel equal to its deckbuilding value, then discard it.

A satisfied Mission remains active until you spend the Action opportunity to complete it. Satisfying the requirement does not complete it automatically.

Aborting and failing

ABORT	After movement, reveal the Active Mission, spend Intel equal to its value, and discard it. Aborting is deliberate and is not failure.
FAIL	Opponent disruption, a compromised game state, or a specific effect causes failure. Reveal the Mission and put it in your Graveyard.
ACTION PRESSURE Starting, completing, aborting, and replacing Missions all compete with ordinary Action-card play. Mission progress is powerful because it costs real tempo.	

2. Special Operation

A Special Operation is Intelligence’s faction victory attempt. You may start one only if Operation Progress is greater than the number of Territories the opponent controls, you have no Active Mission, and you have an Intelligence card in hand with a printed Mission requirement.

START	After movement, instead of playing an Action card, place the Mission card face down as the Special Operation.
REQUIREMENT	Use the card’s printed Mission requirement. It is not a normal Mission and grants no Intel or Operation Progress.
READINESS LOSS	If Operation Progress ceases to exceed opposing controlled Territories, reveal the Special Operation and put it in your Graveyard.
COMPLETE	After movement, reveal a satisfied Special Operation and pay the final Intel cost. If paid, win immediately.
FINAL INTEL COST	
Territories in the Gauntlet – Special Operation card value. Minimum payment: 1 Intel.	

OPERATIONAL TENSION
Higher-value Mission cards are harder to complete, but they generate more Intel as normal Missions and reduce the final Special Operation payment.

Resource tracker

The printable tracker provides spaces for 0–20 Intel and 0–8 Operation Progress. These are not maximums. If a value exceeds the printed spaces, use a die, note, or second marker to record the excess.

Special Operation checklist

- Progress exceeds opposing controlled Territories.
- No Active Mission.
- Eligible Mission card in hand.
- Requirement satisfied after a later movement step.
- Readiness still valid.
- Enough Intel to pay the final cost.

3. Surveillance and Interference

Intelligence effects rely on the normal order of hidden commitments. The attacker commits from hand first, then the defender. The attacker selects from battle draw first, then the defender. Cards reveal after both sources are resolved unless an effect says otherwise.

HAND COMMITMENT	BATTLE DRAW
• Attacker commits face down or passes. • Defender commits face down or passes. • A hand commitment normally goes to the Graveyard after battle.	• Attacker draws and selects face down. • Defender draws and selects face down. • Played battle-drawn cards normally go to discard.

Surveillance

ONCE PER BATTLE

When the opponent commits or selects a face-down Battle card in a battle involving you, spend 1 Intel to look at it before the battle proceeds.

- A defender can inspect the attacker’s hand commitment before deciding their own.
- A defender can inspect the attacker’s selected battle-drawn card before choosing their own.
- An attacker can inspect the defender’s hand commitment before battle draw.
- An attacker can inspect the defender’s selected battle-drawn card before the normal reveal.
- Each Intelligence player may use Surveillance once per battle, including in a mirror match.

Interference

AFTER SURVEILLANCE

Spend 2 additional Intel to remove the inspected card from the battle. The opponent may choose another legal card from the same source, if able.

HAND SOURCE	Return the commitment to its owner’s hand.
BATTLE-DRAW SOURCE	Return the card to that battle draw; it is no longer selected.
NO REPLACEMENT	The opponent plays no card from that source.
DISRUPTION, NOT DESTRUCTION	
Interference does not discard or negate the card and does not create another Surveillance or response window.	

4. Intelligence leaders — Ranger



Know the land before the battle begins.

TERRAIN MASTERY · RECONNAISSANCE · HOSTILE GROUND

RANGER

The Ranger reads the land before armies know they are lost. Where others see forest, river, and stone, the Ranger sees routes, risks, and advantage. The Ranger uses Intel to prevent exposed Territory effects from dictating movement or battle, then combines that freedom with reconnaissance and carefully timed withdrawal.

Choose the Ranger when you want to operate aggressively on revealed Territories, preserve Intel for board positioning, and use faction cards as tactical substitutes for Surveillance.

FIELDRAFT

Once per turn, when a revealed Territory effect would affect you, your movement, or a battle involving you, spend 1 Intel to ignore that Territory effect until end of turn. Fieldcraft does not ignore ownership, occupation, capture, Heartland rules, Homeland Advantage, or Asset-bank limits.

RANGER SIGNATURE

Fieldcraft turns a hostile revealed Territory from an imposed constraint into a calculated route. The Ranger still has to win the battle or secure the ground; he simply chooses when the terrain matters.

Priorities

- Preserve Intel when a hostile Territory could decide movement or battle.
- Use Reconnaissance, Fog of War, and Exfiltration to enter, test, and leave dangerous ground.
- Obtain information through cards when saving Intel for Fieldcraft matters more than Surveillance.
- Complete Missions that arise naturally from occupation and counterattack rather than forcing a fragile sequence.

4. Intelligence leaders — Spymaster



Information never rests. Momentum is the weapon.

MISSION TEMPO • NETWORK COMMAND • COVERT COORDINATION

SPYMASTER

The Spymaster is the architect of covert operations. Each completed Mission immediately becomes the opening of another, allowing a successful network to sustain pressure without spending another Action opportunity merely to restore its hidden objective.

Choose the Spymaster when you want to sequence Missions, protect or revise an operation already in motion, and convert successful objectives into continuous preparation for a Special Operation.

MISSION CONTROL

Once per turn, after completing a normal Mission, immediately start a new Mission from hand without using the Action opportunity. The new Mission cannot complete that turn. Mission Control cannot start a Special Operation.

SPYMASTER SIGNATURE

Mission Control rewards an operation already completed. It preserves momentum by replacing the hidden objective immediately, but it does not complete the new Mission or begin the final Special Operation.

Priorities

- Keep at least one playable Mission card in hand before completing the current Mission.
- Use Operational Reassessment when the board no longer supports the hidden objective.
- Use Deep Cover to make opponent-driven failure costly without making Missions invulnerable.
- Avoid pursuing Operation Progress so mechanically that ordinary territorial pressure is neglected.

5. Playing Intelligence

HOW MUCH DO YOU NEED TO KNOW?

Gather enough information to choose a strong line, then act before the cost of preparation exceeds the value of certainty.

Intelligence’s central tension is immediate action versus prepared certainty. A card used as an Action, Battle effect, Mission, stored Sleeper Network operation, or hand commitment cannot serve all of those roles at once.

STRENGTHS	LIMITS
• Information and adaptation through Spies, Reconnaissance, Intercepted Orders, and Surveillance. • Six varied Missions with accessible, positional, and difficult requirements. • Commitment manipulation through Fog of War and Disinformation. • Specific tactical disruption rather than blanket suppression. • Visible long-term preparation with hidden contents. • Different uses of the same pool under Ranger and Spymaster.	• No forward-movement acceleration or capture shortcut. • No unconditional draw engine and little raw numerical battle strength. • Limited permanent Asset removal. • Mission requirements can become unreachable or fail. • Heavy Action pressure from Mission lifecycle decisions. • Special Operation readiness can collapse when the opponent retakes ground.

Strategic threads

RECONNAISSANCE	Spies; Intercepted Orders; Reconnaissance; Operational Reassessment; Treason
MISSION PLANNING	Spies; Fog of War; Disinformation; Reconnaissance; Assassins; Subversion; Deep Cover
MISDIRECTION	Fog of War; Disinformation; Deep Cover
COUNTEROPERATIONS	Intercepted Orders; Assassins; Subversion; Treason
INFILTRATION	Reconnaissance; Exfiltration
PREPARATION	Fog of War; Deep Cover; Sleeper Network

Playing against Intelligence

- Pressure the board while Intelligence spends Actions on Missions.
- Vary hand commitments so Disinformation and Assassins do not receive automatic value.
- Take Territories to reduce Special Operation readiness and Sleeper Network capacity.
- Force the Ranger to spend Intel on terrain or the Spymaster to complete without another Mission ready.
- Treat Sleeper Network as a timing choice: remove it early and accept one effect, or race the larger operation.

5. Intelligence-specific rules reference

ELIGIBLE MISSION CARD	Only an Intelligence card with a printed Mission requirement may be a normal Mission or Special Operation.
MISSION ZONE	A face-down Mission is not in hand, deck, discard, Graveyard, Asset Bank, or battle draw.
REQUIREMENT TIMING	A requirement counts only while that card is the Active Mission or Special Operation.
NORMAL VS SPECIAL	A Special Operation is not a normal Mission and grants no Intel or Operation Progress.
WITHDRAW VS RETREAT	These remain distinct terms. Reconnaissance and Exfiltration use the normal withdrawal rule.
RETURN TO SOURCE	A returned commitment goes to hand; a returned battle-drawn card goes back to that battle draw.
NEGATED CARD	A negated card has no effect and follows its normal destination unless another rule changes it.
STORED CARDS	Cards beneath Sleeper Network are outside ordinary zones until revealed or moved by its text.
COPIED EFFECTS	Treason follows the core rules for impossible targets, source-dependent text, and bounded copied-effect recursion.
FOG OF WAR ORDERING	For the next battle on its Territory, Intelligence makes each corresponding commitment or selection after the opponent, regardless of attacker or defender status.

DEEP COVER REPLACEMENT

When Deep Cover saves a Mission from failure, the Mission returns to hand instead of going to the Graveyard. It is no longer active and must be started again normally.

Resource tracking

Intel has no maximum. Operation Progress has no printed maximum. The tracker’s highest printed values are convenience limits only; record larger values with a die, note, or additional marker.

6. Canonical Intelligence card pool — page 1

EXFILTRATION COST 1 • Basic

ACTION: Bank Exfiltration as an Asset. After you complete or abort a Mission, you may discard Exfiltration. If you do, withdraw.

BATTLE: If you lose, you may retreat one additional space.

SPIES COST 2 • Advanced

ACTION: Look at your opponent's hand. Draw one card, then discard one card.

BATTLE: Reveal Spies before the other Battle cards. Look at each face-down Battle card your opponent played. You may return your selected battle-drawn card to your battle draw and choose another card from that draw face down.

MISSION: Complete after you look at or reveal an opposing face-down Battle card before the normal reveal, then win that battle.

FOG OF WAR COST 2 • Advanced • Territory Overlay

ACTION: Place Fog of War as an Overlay on a revealed Territory. Remove it after the next battle there. During that battle, make each hand commitment and battle-draw selection after your opponent makes the corresponding choice, regardless of who initiated the battle.

BATTLE: Reveal Fog of War before the other Battle cards. If your opponent played a card from both hand and battle draw, they choose one of those cards and return it to its source. They play no card from that source.

MISSION: Complete after your opponent plays a Battle card from both hand and battle draw in a battle involving you, then loses that battle.

DISINFORMATION COST 2 • Advanced

BATTLE: If you committed Disinformation from hand, reveal it before the other Battle cards. If your opponent also committed from hand, gain advantage. Return Disinformation to your hand during cleanup.

MISSION: Complete after you win a battle in which your opponent committed a Battle card from hand and you did not.

6. Canonical Intelligence card pool — page 2

OPERATIONAL REASSESSMENT COST 3 • Advanced

ACTION: Return your Active Mission to your hand, then place another Intelligence card from your hand with a Mission requirement face down as your Active Mission. It cannot be completed this turn.

BATTLE: After all Battle cards are revealed, you may replace Operational Reassessment with a Battle card from your hand whose Battle effect can still resolve. If you do, put Operational Reassessment in your Graveyard and play that card face up.

INTERCEPTED ORDERS COST 3 • Advanced

ACTION: Bank Intercepted Orders as an Asset. When your opponent draws their initial battle draw in a battle involving you, before they choose a card, you may discard Intercepted Orders. If you do, look at that draw and choose one card. They cannot play that card during this battle.

BATTLE: Reveal Intercepted Orders before the other Battle cards. Look at your opponent's battle draw and choose one card. They cannot play that card during this battle. If it was their selected card, they may choose another legal card from that draw face down.

RECONNAISSANCE COST 3 • Advanced

ACTION: Bank Reconnaissance as an Asset. When a battle you initiated begins, you may discard Reconnaissance to look at your opponent's hand. You may then withdraw before Battle cards are committed.

BATTLE: Reveal Reconnaissance before the other Battle cards. After the remaining Battle cards are revealed, before any of their effects resolve, you may withdraw. If you do, return all other Battle cards to their sources.

MISSION: Complete after you win a battle you did not initiate while occupying an enemy-controlled Territory.

DEEP COVER COST 3 • Advanced

ACTION: Bank Deep Cover as an Asset. When your Active Mission would fail, you may put Deep Cover in your Graveyard. If you do, return that Mission to your hand instead.

BATTLE: If an opposing effect looked at or revealed one of your face-down Battle cards before the normal reveal, gain advantage.

6. Canonical Intelligence card pool — page 3

ASSASSINS COST 4 • Advanced

ACTION: Look at your opponent's hand. Choose one card from it and discard that card.

BATTLE: Reveal Assassins before the other Battle cards. If your opponent committed from hand, reveal and negate that card. Otherwise, give your opponent disadvantage during this battle.

MISSION: Complete after you look at one or more cards in your opponent's hand outside a battle, then win a battle against that opponent in which they committed from hand.

TREASON COST 4 • Advanced

ACTION: Bank Treason as an Asset. After all Battle cards are revealed in a battle involving you, before their effects resolve, you may discard Treason. If you do, choose one opposing Battle card. Negate it, then resolve its Battle effect as though you played it.

BATTLE: Reveal Treason before the other Battle cards. After the remaining Battle cards are revealed, before their effects resolve, choose one opposing Battle card. Negate it, then resolve its Battle effect as though you played it.

SUBVERSION COST 4 • Advanced

ACTION: Bank Subversion as an Asset. When an opposing banked Asset's effect would resolve, you may put Subversion in your Graveyard. If you do, negate that effect and discard that Asset if it remains in play.

BATTLE: Opposing banked Assets cannot be used during this battle.

MISSION: Complete after you win a battle in which your opponent used a banked Asset and you used none.

6. Canonical pool — Sleeper Network

SLEEPER NETWORK COST 5 • Advanced • Unique

ACTION: Bank Sleeper Network as an Asset with one other card from your hand face down beneath it. At the end of each of your later turns, you may place one other card from your hand face down beneath it.

CAPACITY: Sleeper Network can hold no more cards than the number of Territories you control. If it holds too many, immediately discard cards beneath it of your choice until it does not.

ACTIVATE: At the start of your turn, you may put Sleeper Network in your Graveyard. If you do, reveal the cards beneath it. Play each of those cards whose Action effect can legally resolve, one at a time and in any order, without using Action opportunities. Discard the rest.

COMPROMISED: When an opposing effect would cause Sleeper Network to leave play, before it does, reveal the cards beneath it. You may play one of those cards whose Action effect can legally resolve without using an Action opportunity. Discard the rest.

OTHER REMOVAL: If Sleeper Network leaves play for any other reason, discard all cards beneath it.

Pool profile

COST 1	Exfiltration
COST 2	Spies; Fog of War; Disinformation
COST 3	Operational Reassessment; Intercepted Orders; Reconnaissance; Deep Cover
COST 4	Assassins; Treason; Subversion
COST 5	Sleeper Network
TOTAL	12 unique cards · total value 36 · average 3.00
MISSION PROFILE	
Six Mission cards: Spies, Fog of War, Disinformation, Reconnaissance, Assassins, and Subversion. No cost-1 Mission cheaply farms Operation Progress; the cost-4 Missions provide difficult routes to larger Intel rewards.	

A. Quick reference

NORMAL MISSION	SPECIAL OPERATION
• After movement, instead of an Action card, place an eligible Intelligence card face down. • It cannot complete that turn; its requirement counts only while active. • Later, after movement, reveal and complete it instead of an Action card. • Gain 1 Operation Progress and Intel equal to its value; discard it. • Abort by paying Intel equal to value and discarding. Failure sends it to the Graveyard.	• Progress must exceed opposing controlled Territories. • Have no Active Mission and use an eligible Mission card. • If readiness is lost, the Special Operation fails. • Satisfy its requirement after a later movement step. • Pay Territories in the Gauntlet – card value, minimum 1 Intel, to win.

Surveillance and Interference

SURVEILLANCE	Once per battle, spend 1 Intel to look at one opposing face-down Battle card when it is committed or selected.
INTERFERENCE	After Surveillance, spend 2 more Intel to remove that card. The opponent may replace it from the same source.

Leaders

RANGER	Fieldcraft — once per turn, spend 1 Intel to ignore a revealed Territory effect affecting you, your movement, or your battle until end of turn.
SPYMASTER	Mission Control — once per turn after completing a normal Mission, immediately start another Mission from hand. It cannot complete that turn and cannot be the Special Operation.

Cards by cost

1	Exfiltration
2	Spies; Fog of War; Disinformation
3	Operational Reassessment; Intercepted Orders; Reconnaissance; Deep Cover
4	Assassins; Treason; Subversion
5	Sleeper Network
RELEASE AUTHORITY The definitive Markdown guide governs Intelligence-specific text. This DOCX and the adjacent PDF are release-formatted editions. The package remains subject to playtesting and the project-wide copied-effect rules required by Treason.	